

SCALEUP WEEK

A revenue maturity workshop

Building the Growth Engine

From Founder-Led Sales to Scalable Revenue Systems

Joseph Fung

01 Founder-led sales works until it doesn't

The founder is not just selling. They are compressing *product, market, vision, credibility, pricing, roadmap, and exceptions* into one conversation.

The goal is not to clone the founder. **The goal is to build a system others can run.**

02 Why employees can't sell like founders

Above all of these: buyers want the founder to win, so they seek reasons to buy. With a rep, the instinct flips — they seek reasons to say no.

Context

They did not live through every customer conversation, product decision, false start, and investor pitch.

Pattern recognition

The founder has thousands of mental reps. The employee has whatever the company makes explicit.

Authority

They cannot promise exceptions, influence the roadmap, or reset expectations the way a founder can.

Permission

Founders improvise. Employees need judgment, guardrails, and a clear definition of a good deal.

Copying the founder is a trap. *Translating the founder is the job.*

03 The sales school problem

Osmosis is not onboarding. If others need to sell well, *you need a curriculum.*

01 ICP and personas

02 Discovery and qualification

03 Messaging and proof

04 Demo paths

05 Objection handling

06 Pricing guardrails

07 Handoff to Customer Success

Without a system, every new hire starts from zero — ramp is slow, coaching is random, and performance depends on heroics.

04 The carpenter-with-no-tools problem

A professional rep still needs the right *tools and operating environment*.

TOOLS AND SYSTEMS

- CRM discipline
- Sales stages
- Qualification criteria
- Discovery guides
- Proof and collateral

OPERATING DISCIPLINE

- Manager cadence
- Forecast method
- Clean handoffs
- Comp and territories
- Feedback loops

Hiring talent into a weak system creates **expensive disappointment**.

05 The rose-coloured ICP problem

Who *can* buy is not the same as who *should* buy. Founder optimism is useful early — it becomes dangerous when the team scales against a fuzzy target.

SIGNALS

- Pipeline looks big, but quality is uneven
- Reps chase edge cases because the founder once closed one
- Discounting hides poor fit
- Customer Success inherits vague promises
- Win / loss reasons stay mushy

The fix is not always more pipeline. Sometimes it is a smaller target.

06 TribeHR: from Paul to a real engine

○ STEP 1

Founder-led

Context and credibility lived with the founding team.

● STEP 2

First sales rep

Paul was excellent because he learned the pattern early and deeply.

● STEP 3

6 reps + CRO

The motion became managed, coached, and repeatable.

● STEP 4

Vertical playbook

Rolled into key verticals and a broader international sales pool.

The first great rep proves the motion. **Scaling requires making the motion legible to everyone else.**

07 A revenue engine is not a sales team

A sales team is people. A revenue engine is the *operating system* that helps competent people produce repeatable results.

*The framework gives you a way to find the **weakest part** of that operating system.*

Revenue Growth Engine

Maturity Framework

Four stages of growth-engine maturity. Find where you are; identify the next level that most **unlocks growth**.



09 Market Fit

THE QUESTION

Do we know where we win repeatedly?

COMMON FAILURE MODE

The company treats every interested buyer as a valid target.

ONE LEVEL-UP MOVE

Narrow the ICP, sharpen the message, and stop treating every lead as equal.

10 Sales Process

THE QUESTION

Can we predict and manage revenue?

COMMON FAILURE MODE

Stages exist in the CRM, but do not reflect real buyer progress.

ONE LEVEL-UP MOVE

Define exit criteria, coach the pipeline, and make forecasting a management rhythm.

11 Enablement

THE QUESTION

Can new people become productive without osmosis?

COMMON FAILURE MODE

Knowledge lives with founders or top performers, so ramp depends on proximity.

ONE LEVEL-UP MOVE

Turn founder knowledge into onboarding, certification, coaching, and practical playbooks.

12 Technology

THE QUESTION

Do tools reinforce the system?

COMMON FAILURE MODE

The stack creates dashboards, but not better decisions or better rep behavior.

ONE LEVEL-UP MOVE

Use CRM, automation, and AI to reduce friction and improve execution.

13 Retention & Expansion

THE QUESTION

Does revenue compound after the first sale?

COMMON FAILURE MODE

Sales closes the deal, then CS discovers the promises and problems later.

ONE LEVEL-UP MOVE

Create a managed customer lifecycle with clean handoffs, health metrics, and expansion plays.

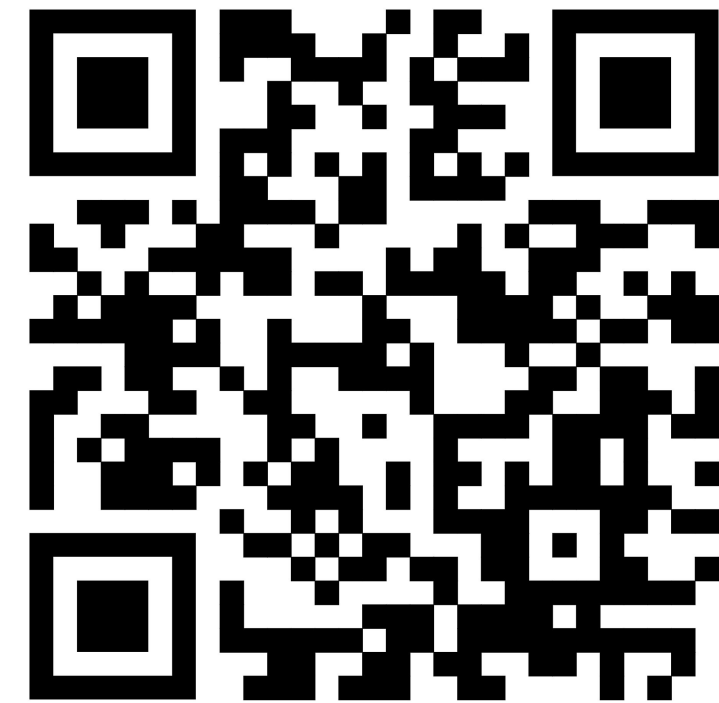
14 Case study: HarbourStack

HarbourStack is a 6-year-old SaaS company helping mid-sized logistics and field-service teams manage scheduling, dispatch, compliance paperwork, and customer updates.

They grew to **\$3.8M ARR** through founder-led sales, referrals, and a handful of strong early customer wins.

HIGH-LEVEL SIGNALS

- Hired a VP Sales, 4 AEs, 2 SDRs, and a marketing lead
- Implemented HubSpot, call recording, dashboards, and paid campaigns
- Pipeline grew from \$1.4M to \$4.2M and demos doubled
- Net new ARR stayed flat, sales cycles stretched, and churn rose



FULL CASE STUDY

Scan for the full write-up

Every input went up. Net new ARR did not.

HARBOURSTACK

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Exercise: diagnose the imbalance

Pick the weakest one or two dimensions. Then answer:

What should HarbourStack fix before adding more sales capacity?

OTHER DIAGNOSTIC QUESTIONS

- Where is the system least mature?
- What would make the problem worse?
- What symptom is misleading?
- What would you fix first?

Diagnose before you prescribe.

THE FIVE DIMENSIONS – THE SAME LANES FROM THE FRAMEWORK

01 Market Fit	Do we know where we win repeatedly?
02 Sales Process	Can we predict and manage revenue?
03 Enablement	Can new people become productive without osmosis?
04 Technology	Do tools reinforce the system?
05 Retention & Expansion	Does revenue compound after the first sale?

HARBOURSTACK

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Actual diagnosis

Dimension		Likely Stage	Why
Market Fit		Stage 2	Strong pockets of fit, but the ICP is still too loose.
Sales Process		Stage 3	Stages, reviews, and forecasting rhythms exist.
Enablement	Focus Here	Stage 1	Founder knowledge has not been translated into a teachable system.
Technology		Stage 3	CRM, dashboards, and call recording are in place.
Retention & Expansion		Stage 2	A CS motion exists, but handoffs and expansion are weak.

Core bottleneck: Enablement + Market Fit. Retention shows the downstream damage.

JOSEPH FUNG

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ACT 1

What happened next: the wrong fix

They added fuel to a leaky engine.

ACTIONS
Hired two more AEs
Increased paid spend by 60%
Bought a better outbound platform
Celebrated more meetings and demos

TWO QUARTERS LATER	
CAC	increased ↑ 42%
Net new ARR	barely moved
Sales cycles	above 90 days
AE attrition	2 missed quota, left
Gross revenue churn	rose to 19%
NRR	dropped below 90%

More fuel, same leak.

ACT 2

18 What happened next: the real fix

THE REAL FIX

1 · Narrowed the ICP

Regional field-service companies with 75–300 employees, multiple branches, high compliance burden, and spreadsheet-heavy dispatch.

2 · Turned founder knowledge into enablement

Discovery questions, a good-fit guide, demo paths, objection handling, pricing guardrails, and annotated founder calls.

3 · Repaired the Sales-to-CS handoff

Every deal needs a business outcome, sponsor, implementation owner, first milestone, risks, and an expansion hypothesis.

NINE MONTHS LATER

Sales cycle	91 → 63 days
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Win rate in ICP	18% → 31%
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Gross churn	19% → 10%
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Expansion revenue	6% → 18%
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AE ramp	7 → 4 months
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Founder in late-stage deals	< 20%
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Fix the engine first. **Then add fuel.**

19 Now assess your own company

Pick your current level in each dimension. Then pick the *one dimension* to move up next.

Market Fit

Sales Process

Enablement

Technology

Retention & Expansion

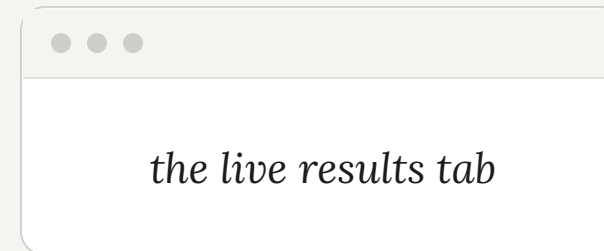


SELF-ASSESSMENT

Scan to benchmark your company

Do not average the scores. Look for the constraint that most limits growth right now.

20 Live benchmark results



PRESENTER CUE · FOR JOSEPH'S EYES ONLY

Joseph, switch to the browser

This is the part where you stop talking, pull up the live benchmark results, and share the screen.

Yes — this entire slide exists to remind you.

Switch back here once the room has had a good look at the numbers.

21 CLOSE Commit to one level-up

One topic. One level. *One next move.*

Thank you.

Find peers working on the same constraint before you leave.

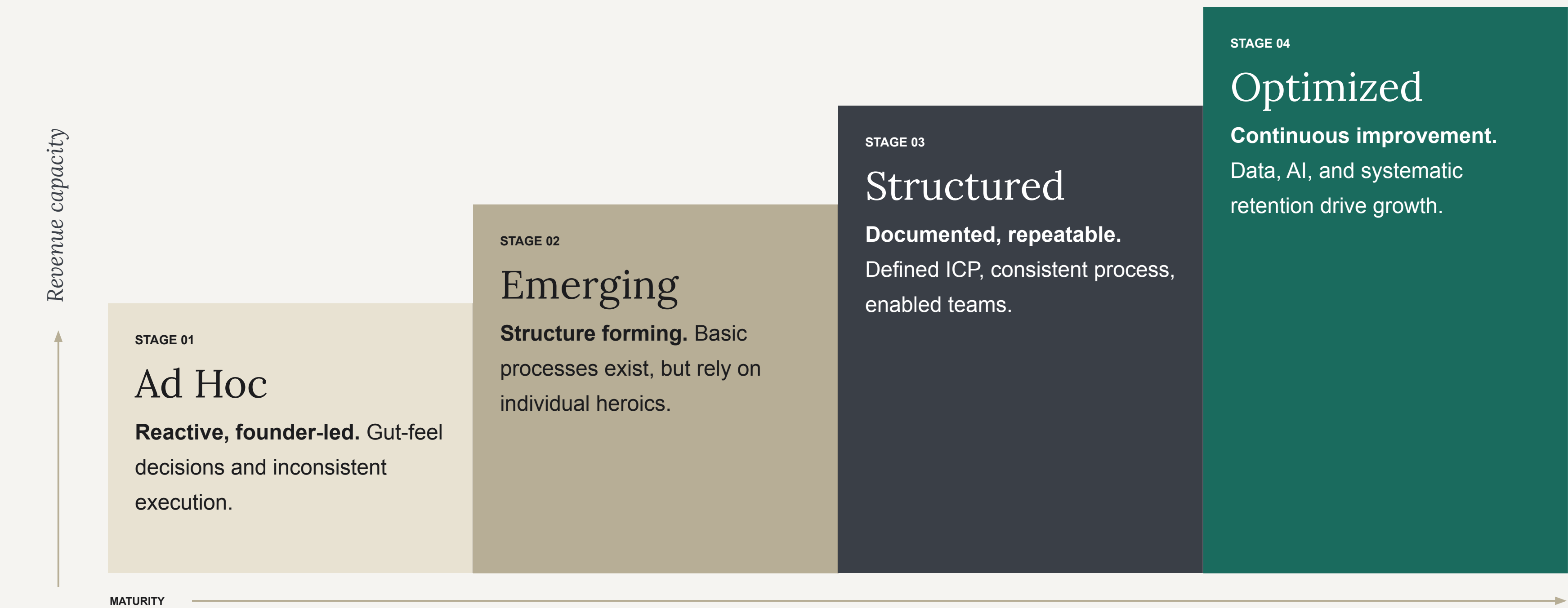
A Appendix

The complete maturity framework

Revenue Growth Engine

Maturity Framework

Four stages of growth-engine maturity. Find where you are; identify the next level that most **unlocks growth**.



01 Market Fit

How well we know who we sell to, and how we reach them.

STAGE 01 Ad Hoc WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE ● Founder-led discovery and selling ● ICP is loose or shifting ● Messaging varies by person and channel ● Leads are mostly referral-driven SIGNALS ● Low inbound conversion ● High variance in lead quality ● Unclear win/loss reasons	STAGE 02 Emerging WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE ● Basic ICP and personas exist ● Messaging is becoming repeatable ● Sales and marketing starting to align ● A few lead channels show promise SIGNALS ● Improving lead quality ● Early repeatable channels ● Basic segment / persona segmentation	STAGE 03 Structured WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE ● ICP is clear and consistently targeted ● Messaging is aligned across GTM ● Lead gen is planned and measurable ● Competitive positioning understood SIGNALS ● Predictable pipeline creation ● Consistent conversion by segment ● More stable CAC	STAGE 04 Optimized WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE ● Targeting and positioning improve continuously ● Segmentation is deep and data-backed ● Product, sales, marketing share feedback loops ● AI and data improve targeting and messaging SIGNALS ● High pipeline efficiency ● Strong win rates in target segments ● Improving CAC payback and LTV:CAC
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02 Sales Process

How we move qualified opportunities to closed revenue.

STAGE 01

Ad Hoc

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Deals depend on founder judgment
- Sales stages unclear or inconsistent
- Forecasting is mostly guesswork
- Territories, quotas, comp are reactive

SIGNALS

- Unpredictable revenue
- Deals stall without warning
- Frequent forecast misses

STAGE 02

Emerging

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Basic CRM stages exist
- Early playbooks are forming
- Pipeline reviews happen, but unevenly
- Compensation plans partially defined

SIGNALS

- Better forecast visibility
- Some funnel conversion tracking
- Inconsistent CRM hygiene

STAGE 03

Structured

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Sales methodology is documented
- Forecasting process is consistent
- Territories, quotas, comp align to strategy
- Pipeline management is actively coached

SIGNALS

- Predictable pipeline coverage
- Improving forecast accuracy
- Consistent stage conversion

STAGE 04

Optimized

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Process improves through data and review
- Forecasting and pipeline analysis use AI / data
- Sales operating discipline is strong
- Territory and comp models are stress-tested

SIGNALS

- High forecast accuracy
- Shorter sales cycles
- Consistent quota attainment

03 Enablement

How we hire, ramp, and develop the people who sell.

STAGE 01

Ad Hoc

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Hiring is reactive
- Onboarding is informal or absent
- Knowledge lives with founders or top reps
- Coaching happens sporadically

SIGNALS

- Long ramp times
- Wide rep performance variance
- Heavy reliance on heroics

STAGE 02

Emerging

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Basic onboarding materials exist
- Coaching rhythms are forming
- Hiring profile is becoming clearer
- Peer learning happens informally

SIGNALS

- Ramp time improving slowly
- Moderate rep consistency
- Some internal promotion potential

STAGE 03

Structured

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Onboarding and ongoing training are structured
- Role expectations and competencies are clear
- Coaching, certification, peer mentoring exist
- Knowledge is documented and accessible

SIGNALS

- Predictable ramp time
- Consistent attainment distribution
- Lower voluntary turnover

STAGE 04

Optimized

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Enablement is tied to performance data
- AI supports coaching and call analysis
- Learning systems improve over time
- Internal leadership pipeline is intentional

SIGNALS

- Fast ramp-to-productivity
- Strong internal promotion rates
- High attainment consistency

04 Technology

How systems, data, and automation support GTM execution.

STAGE 01

Ad Hoc

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Tools are disconnected or spreadsheet-heavy
- CRM is incomplete or poorly maintained
- Reporting is manual and reactive
- Automation is limited

SIGNALS

- Low CRM adoption
- Poor data quality
- Heavy manual admin work

STAGE 02

Emerging

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Core CRM and basic tools are in place
- Some dashboards and automation exist
- Reporting is improving, but inconsistent
- AI experiments are starting

SIGNALS

- Better pipeline visibility
- Less manual reporting
- Partial workflow automation

STAGE 03

Structured

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- GTM systems and workflows are integrated
- CRM hygiene and reporting are consistent
- Automation supports key processes
- AI is embedded where it clearly helps

SIGNALS

- Reliable reporting and attribution
- High CRM compliance
- Faster operational cycles

STAGE 04

Optimized

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- RevOps ecosystem is integrated and scalable
- AI insights shape decisions and actions
- Predictive analytics are used regularly
- Tooling strategy is reviewed and optimized

SIGNALS

- High forecasting confidence
- Lower operational overhead
- Faster decision velocity

05 Retention & Expansion

How we retain customers and grow them over time.

STAGE 01

Ad Hoc

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Customer success is reactive or absent
- Renewals depend on founders or relationships
- Upsells are opportunistic
- Customer health visibility is limited

SIGNALS

- High churn risk
- Inconsistent expansion
- Low customer engagement

STAGE 02

Emerging

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Basic CS motions are forming
- Renewal ownership is defined
- Some account planning exists
- Early customer health tracking in place

SIGNALS

- Stabilizing churn
- Early expansion revenue
- Some renewal predictability

STAGE 03

Structured

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Customer lifecycle is managed intentionally
- CS, support, and account mgmt are aligned
- Expansion motions are systematic
- Customer health metrics drive action

SIGNALS

- Strong gross retention
- Improving NRR
- Consistent expansion pipeline

STAGE 04

Optimized

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

- Retention and expansion are core growth levers
- Predictive churn / expansion models are used
- Advocacy and partner motions are mature
- Customer insights feed product and GTM

SIGNALS

- High NRR
- Strong referrals and advocacy
- Expansion is a major growth driver

Revenue Growth Engine Maturity Framework

A self-assessment across five dimensions and four stages of maturity. The goal is not perfection — it is identifying the dimension that most limits growth today.

5 DIMENSIONS
4 STAGES OF MATURITY

DIMENSION <i>vs. stage</i> MATURITY →				
	STAGE 01 Ad Hoc	STAGE 02 Emerging	STAGE 03 Structured	STAGE 04 Optimized
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Most companies are not uniformly mature across all five dimensions — a single weak dimension often becomes the bottleneck that limits growth.